ACS MILESTONE 7

User Guide

This guide explains how to run the current application, play the sample adventure, save progress, use the editor, make a simple map edit, and move from a local draft to a published release.

What is included right now

- The playable runtime at `apps/web/index.html`
- The browser editor at `apps/web/editor.html`
- The local project and release API at `apps/api/dist/index.js`

Starting The Application

Build the workspace if needed, then start both servers from the repo root.

Web Server

```
node .\apps\web\server.mjs
```

Default URL:

```
http://localhost:4173/
```

Common alternate URL in this environment:

```
http://localhost:4317/
```

API Server

```
node .\apps\api\dist\index.js
```

Local API check:

```
http://localhost:4318/api/session
```

Playing The Game

The runtime can load the built-in sample adventure, a local draft playtest, or a published release.

Sample objective

1. Speak to the Oracle.
2. Enter the shrine.
3. Claim the Solar Seal.

4. Return to the Oracle.

Keyboard controls

- `WASD` or arrow keys move
- `E` interacts
- `Q` inspects
- `Enter` or `Space` advances dialogue

Runtime panels

- Map and player position
- Session source
- Objective panel
- Save controls
- State summary and event log

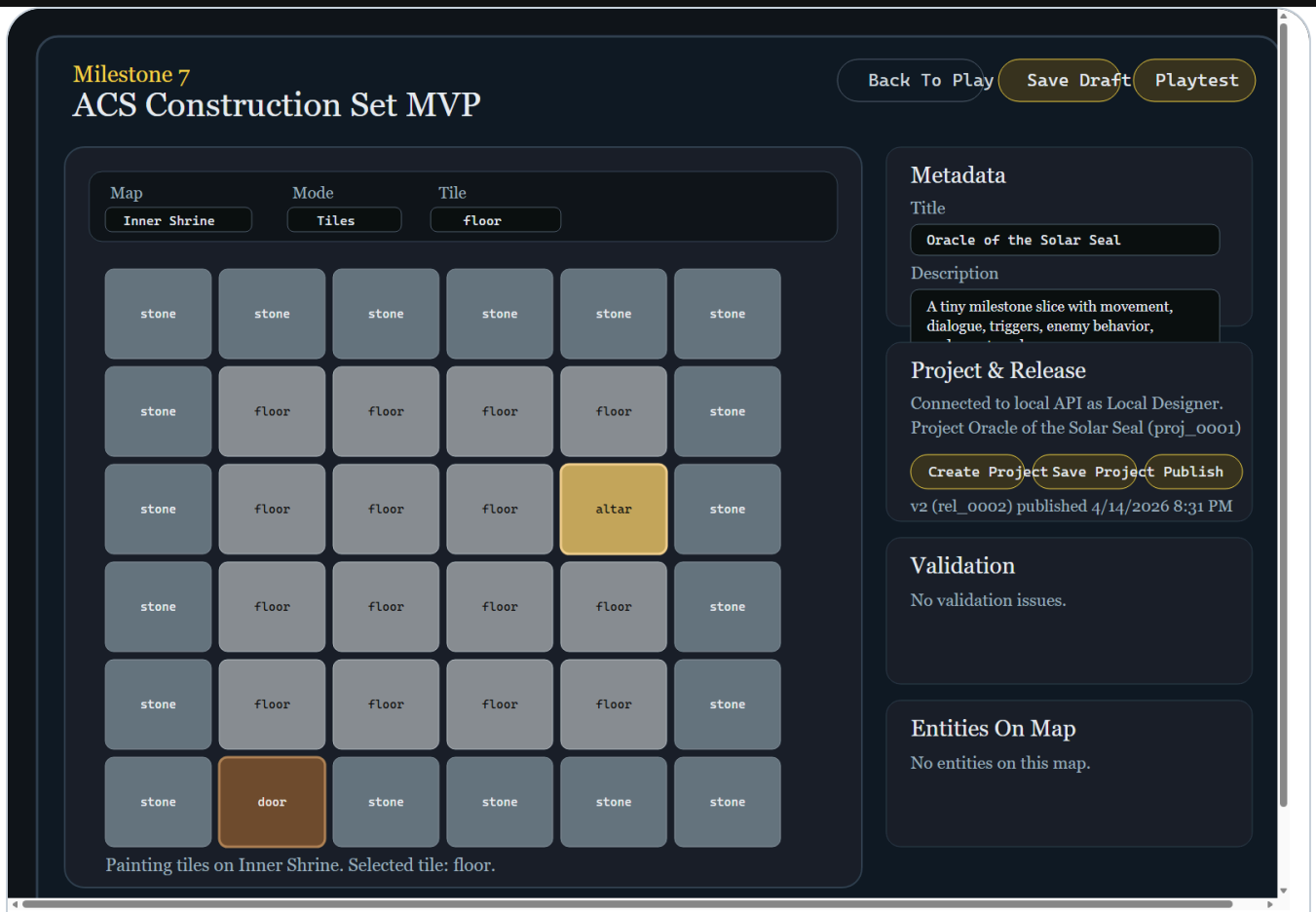
Saving And Loading Progress

The runtime uses separate local save slots for the sample adventure, draft playtests, and published releases.

- **Save** stores the current runtime snapshot in IndexedDB.
- **Load** restores the most recent snapshot for the current source.
- **Reset** restarts the live session without deleting the saved snapshot.

Using The Editor

Open the editor at `http://localhost:4317/apps/web/editor.html`.



The current editor supports metadata editing, tile painting with a persistent brush, repositioning existing entities, validation, local draft saves, backend project saves, publishing releases, and opening those releases in the runtime.

Top buttons

- `Back To Play`
- `Save Draft`
- `Reset Draft`
- `Playtest Draft`

Toolbar controls

- `Map` chooses the current map
- `Mode` switches between Tiles and Entities
- `Tile` picks the tile to paint
- `Entity` picks the existing entity to move
- `Active Brush` shows the currently loaded tile brush in tile mode

Tile Editing

1. Choose `Tiles` mode.
2. Select a tile id from the dropdown.
3. Check the `Active Brush` preview to confirm the selected tile.
4. Click a cell in the grid to paint a single tile, or click and drag to paint across multiple cells.

The selected tile stays loaded like a brush until you choose a different tile.

Entity Editing

1. Choose `Entities` mode.
2. Select an existing entity instance.
3. Click the destination cell.

Current limitation: the editor can move existing entities, but it does not yet create or delete them.

Validation

The validation panel runs the shared schema validator on the current draft and shows either `No validation issues.` or a list of problems.

Tutorial: Make A Simple Map Edit And Play It

Because the current editor cannot create a brand-new map yet, the easiest useful tutorial is to modify one of the built-in maps and then playtest the edited version.

Goal of this tutorial

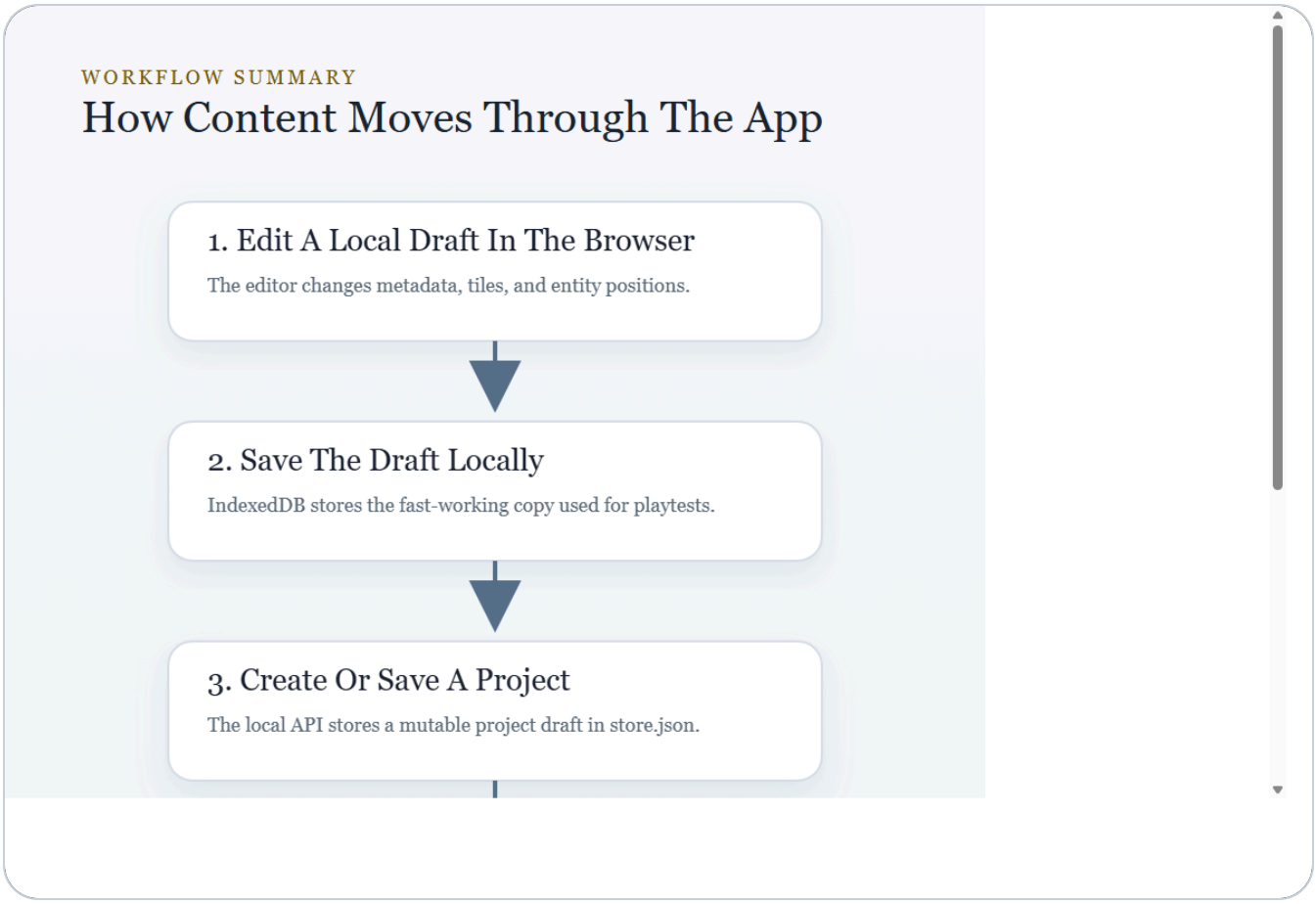
We will edit `Inner Shrine`, paint a few tiles to make the room feel different, save the draft, and open that draft in the runtime.

1. Open the editor at `http://localhost:4317/apps/web/editor.html`.
2. Choose `Inner Shrine` in the `Map` dropdown.
3. Set `Mode` to `Tiles`.
4. Select `floor` in the `Tile` dropdown.

5. Use the selected tile like a brush. Click individual cells or hold the mouse button down and drag across multiple cells to paint continuously.
6. Leave the `door` tile in place so the map exit still works.
7. Leave the `altar` tile in place if you still want the shrine reward trigger to work.
8. Optionally change the adventure title in the metadata panel so your draft is easy to recognize.
9. Click `Save Draft`.
10. Click `Playtest Draft`.
11. In the new runtime tab, walk to the shrine and confirm that the room layout matches your edits.

If the local API is running, you can continue by clicking `Create Project`, `Save Project`, `Publish Release`, and then `Open Latest Release`.

Projects And Published Releases



The editor can move a draft through four project stages:

1. **Create Project**: create a mutable backend project from the current draft.

2. **Save Project**: update the mutable backend draft.
3. **Publish Release**: create an immutable release snapshot.
4. **Open Latest Release**: launch that published release in the runtime.

Important distinction

- `Save Draft` writes to browser storage.
- `Save Project` writes to the local API.
- `Publish Release` freezes a release snapshot rather than editing it in place.

Where Data Lives

Browser storage

- Runtime saves
- Local drafts
- Remembered active project id

Local API storage

- Mutable project drafts
- Immutable published releases
- Stored locally in `apps/api/data/store.json`

Current Limitations

- No real user accounts yet
- No cloud backend yet
- No asset upload flow yet
- No creation or deletion of maps in the editor yet
- No creation or deletion of entity instances in the editor yet
- No trigger editor or dialogue editor yet
- The runtime still uses simple colored tiles and abstract markers

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Troubleshooting

The editor says the API is unavailable

```
node .\apps\api\dist\index.js
```

A published release will not open

- The API may not be running.
- The release id may not exist anymore.
- The local API store may have been cleared.

My draft changes are gone

- Use `Save Draft` for browser-local storage.
- Use `Save Project` for backend storage.

Playtest Draft opens the sample adventure instead

The runtime falls back to the built-in sample when it cannot find the draft key passed by the editor.